

Ellan Vannin Wealth Management

Sovereign Infrastructure Investment Memorandum

The Fylde–Furness Tidal Gateway

Fleetwood – Barrow-in-Furness Tidal Barrage, Energy & Northern Coastal Railway

A Manx Sovereign Wealth Fund Style Infrastructure Investment Proposal

Executive Investment Summary

Ellan Vannin Wealth Management (EVWM) proposes the creation of a sovereign-style infrastructure investment platform focused on acquiring and developing transformational long-life assets.

The flagship investment:

The Fylde–Furness Tidal Gateway

A combined:

- tidal energy barrage
- strategic road crossing
- new heavy rail corridor
- coastal flood defence system
- industrial regeneration zone

connecting:

Fleetwood, Lancashire

through

Morecambe Bay

to

Barrow-in-Furness, Cumbria

The project creates an entirely new economic geography:

The Irish Sea Northern Arc

Blackpool → Fleetwood → Tidal Gateway → Barrow → Lake District → Cumbria

1. Investment Thesis

"Connect two isolated economic assets and create a new northern powerhouse"

The North West contains two powerful but disconnected economies:

The Fylde Economic Zone

Centred around:

- Blackpool
- Fleetwood
- Poulton-le-Fylde
- Lancashire coast

Strengths:

- tourism
 - housing growth
 - services
 - offshore wind supply chain
 - population density
-

The Furness Economic Zone

Centred around:

- Barrow-in-Furness
- Ulverston
- Walney Island

Strengths:

- submarine manufacturing

- defence technology
 - engineering
 - offshore energy
 - advanced manufacturing
-

Currently these economies are separated by Morecambe Bay.

The proposed infrastructure converts:

A geographical barrier

into

A productive economic corridor.

2. Strategic Infrastructure Vision

Phase One

Fleetwood Rail Renaissance

A reopened railway connection:

Blackpool North

Poulton-le-Fylde

Fleetwood

The Fleetwood railway reopening has already been examined by Lancashire County Council, with proposals focused on restoring the disused connection into the national rail network at Poulton-le-Fylde.

Phase Two

The Fylde–Furness Tidal Crossing

A new barrage:

Fleetwood Peninsula

Morecambe Bay

Barrow-in-Furness

Phase Three

Furness Coastal Railway Extension

New railway:

Fleetwood

→ Barrage Rail Deck

→ Barrow Central

→ Walney Island Industrial Zone

3. Why Fleetwood?

The Fleetwood option creates a much larger economic impact than a simple Morecambe crossing.

It connects:

The largest population centres

Blackpool urban area:

~350,000+ people

Lancashire coast:

~500,000+

Cumbria:

~500,000+

Instead of:

Lancaster ↔ Barrow

the investment creates:

Blackpool ↔ Barrow

A much larger labour market.

4. Infrastructure Specification

A. Fylde–Furness Tidal Barrage

Indicative:

Asset	Specification
Location	Morecambe Bay
Northern landing	Fleetwood/Fylde
Western landing	Barrow-in-Furness
Length	~25–35km route corridor
Technology	tidal range barrage
Asset life	100+ years

Existing Morecambe Bay tidal concepts demonstrate the technical opportunity of a large barrage system, with proposals involving around 132 turbines and approximately 7.8 TWh/year generation potential.

B. Electricity Generation

The barrage becomes:

Britain's largest predictable renewable asset

Potential:

7.8 TWh annually

Equivalent to powering approximately millions of homes.

Revenue Model

Assumption:

7.8 TWh × £90/MWh

=

£700 million annual electricity revenue

Additional:

- grid balancing
- capacity payments
- renewable certificates

Potential:

£800m/year energy revenues

C. Northern Coastal Railway

Proposed Service:

Blackpool – Fleetwood – Barrow

Modern electric railway.

Journey Times

Current:

Blackpool → Barrow

Requires:

- south/east routing
- interchange
- long journey times

Future:

Blackpool North

↓

Fleetwood

↓

Tidal Gateway

↓

Barrow

Target:

60 minutes

5. Economic Impact Model

Creation of the "Bay City Region"

The project integrates:

Location	Economic Role
Blackpool	population/services/tourism
Fleetwood	port/offshore energy
Lancashire	manufacturing
Barrow	defence engineering
Cumbria	energy/tourism

GDP Expansion Calculation

Current Combined Economy

Approximate affected economy:

Blackpool + Fylde + Wyre + Furness + South Cumbria

≈

£30 billion regional economy

Productivity Impact

Transport infrastructure creates:

- larger labour markets
- reduced commuting friction
- industrial clustering
- investment attraction

Assume:

3% productivity uplift

=

£900 million additional annual GDP

Agglomeration Benefit

A successful northern corridor could generate:

Additional:

£1–2 billion annual economic activity

over several decades.

6. Industrial Renaissance Opportunities

1. Barrow Defence Growth

The link supports:

- submarine supply chains
 - engineering recruitment
 - specialist manufacturing
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2. Fleetwood Offshore Energy Hub

Fleetwood becomes:

Irish Sea Energy Gateway

Supporting:

- offshore wind
 - tidal maintenance
 - marine engineering
-

3. Green Hydrogen Economy

Using tidal electricity:

Potential:

- hydrogen production
- maritime fuels

- industrial decarbonisation
-

4. Tourism Transformation

Creates:

The Western Lake District Gateway

Visitors could travel:

Blackpool

→ Fleetwood

→ Barrow

→ Lake District

without the current geographic barrier.

7. Investment Structure

EVWM Northern Renaissance Infrastructure Fund

Target:

£20 billion fund

Capital Sources

Investor	Allocation
Manx anchor capital	£3bn
UK pension funds	£6bn
Insurance investors	£4bn
Sovereign investors	£4bn
Infrastructure funds	£3bn

Ownership Strategy

EVWM becomes:

Long-term asset owner

Holding:

- energy assets
 - rail infrastructure
 - development land
 - operating companies
-

8. Project Economics

Capital Requirement

Estimated:

Component	Cost
Barrage	£12bn
Rail infrastructure	£3bn
Fleetwood rail reopening	£250m–£500m
Stations/development	£1bn
Grid/hydrogen	£2bn

Total:

£18–20 billion

Annual Revenues

Source	Annual
Electricity	£700m–800m
Rail operations	£100m
Road access	£100m
Industrial development	£200m
Grid services	£100m

Total:

£1.2 billion+ annual income

Investment Return

Target:

Infrastructure IRR

7–10%

Asset characteristics:

- ✓ 100-year lifespan
 - ✓ Inflation-linked revenue
 - ✓ Strategic national importance
 - ✓ Renewable energy income
 - ✓ Transport monopoly characteristics
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9. EVWM Strategic Position

This becomes the defining asset of:

Ellan Vannin Wealth Management

A Manx equivalent of:

- Norway's infrastructure ownership model
 - Singapore sovereign investment model
 - Canadian pension infrastructure strategy
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The Isle of Man becomes:

The capital partner of Northern Britain's renaissance

10. Final Investment Recommendation

Ellan Vannin Wealth Management should establish:

The Fylde–Furness Tidal Gateway Fund

with the objective of creating:

The first integrated energy and transport sovereign infrastructure asset in Northern England.

The investment creates:

Energy sovereignty

7.8 TWh predictable renewable generation

Transport transformation

Blackpool connected directly to Cumbria

Industrial renewal

Fleetwood offshore energy + Barrow defence manufacturing

Regional GDP growth

£1bn+ annual economic uplift potential

Final Investment Thesis

The project is not a bridge.

It is:

A new northern economic spine.

For 200 years, Morecambe Bay separated Lancashire and Cumbria.

The Fylde–Furness Tidal Gateway turns that separation into the foundation of a new industrial civilisation on the Irish Sea.